

Pain-Confidence

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Introduction

Welcome to 'Pain-Confidence', the fourth module in the Copywriting 101 course. In this module, we'll cover the significance of pain, how to generate pain in your audience, and how to leverage that pain to lead to the actions you want.

DISCLAIMER: I highly recommend watching every previous module before watching this module, as we'll be building on the concepts we learned there. If you don't understand those concepts in depth, applying the concepts you'll learn here will be harder and more complicated.

Link to the FULL video version: [Pain-Confidence Video](#)

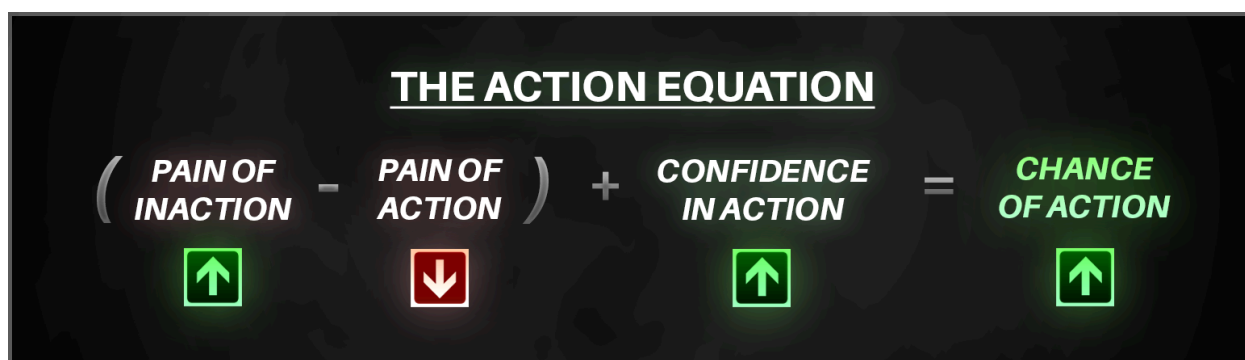
Link to the mastersheet: [Copywriting Mastersheet](#)

join copy skool: <https://www.skool.com/copyskool>

The Action Equation

Your job as a copywriter is to create action, and pain fuels action.

We can visualize this with 'The Action Equation':



If the pain of inaction is **GREATER** than the pain of action, **AND** they're confident that the action will **ALLEVIATE** that pain... they'll take the action.

If you're having trouble persuading people to take the actions you want, this equation can clarify what to fix... by focusing on the pain.

If you want to become an effective copywriter, **you must become a master of pain.**

You must learn where pain comes from.

You must learn how to create pain in your audience.

You must learn how to leverage that pain into specific actions.

We'll cover each of these in this module.

WARNING: These concepts are powerful. By learning to create pain in someone, you influence how they act. Promise me you'll focus on creating 'productive pain' — pain that leads to someone creating positive change in their life. (*Losing weight vs. old people phone scams.*)

Pain Origins

Until we breathe our last breath — *or Jesus returns* — **we're continuously in SOME form of pain.**

While that may sound a bit weird/depressing, *it isn't!*

Pain motivates us to work, set goals, and create solutions.

Although we may be experiencing some form of pain, we aren't always 'aware' of that pain, and we don't always know what exactly is causing that pain.

This is also why we love distracting ourselves from life, work, etc. We try to become unaware of the pain we're feeling.

> *'Ignorance is bliss' 'Flow state' 'Doom scrolling'*

★ Your job as a copywriter is to **bring awareness to the pain your audience is in** and **'blame' that pain on a specific problem that your product/service solves.**

(Reminder, we are doing this to HELP people change for the BETTER. Positive pain!)



Jovan 8/30/24, 6:37 PM

Some late-night thoughts for my brothers, maybe this helps some of you...

Now, I'll be going off the topic, but I just wanted to say something you all probably know, just as a reminder I guess...

Quick context: I was taking a break from a 6-hour account setup and decided to watch KJ's raw channel. He talked about pain and procrastination and I immediately remembered the pain of accounts setup and offer creation that we all had to go through.

Then something hit me all of a sudden... I would've NEVER gone through that if I hadn't invested a lot of money to join here AND the time beforehand to get to that kind of money (months of savings and work by the way, in Serbia at least, that's a hell of a lot).

So, if I bought this same information (which is not possible, but let's just pretend, hypothetically speaking) for \$200, maybe even \$1000, I **know** I would've worked a lot less and procrastinated much more to create that offer, set up accounts, learn, etc. (or maybe not do it at all, and just say, it's not worth it, I don't even know if it will work)

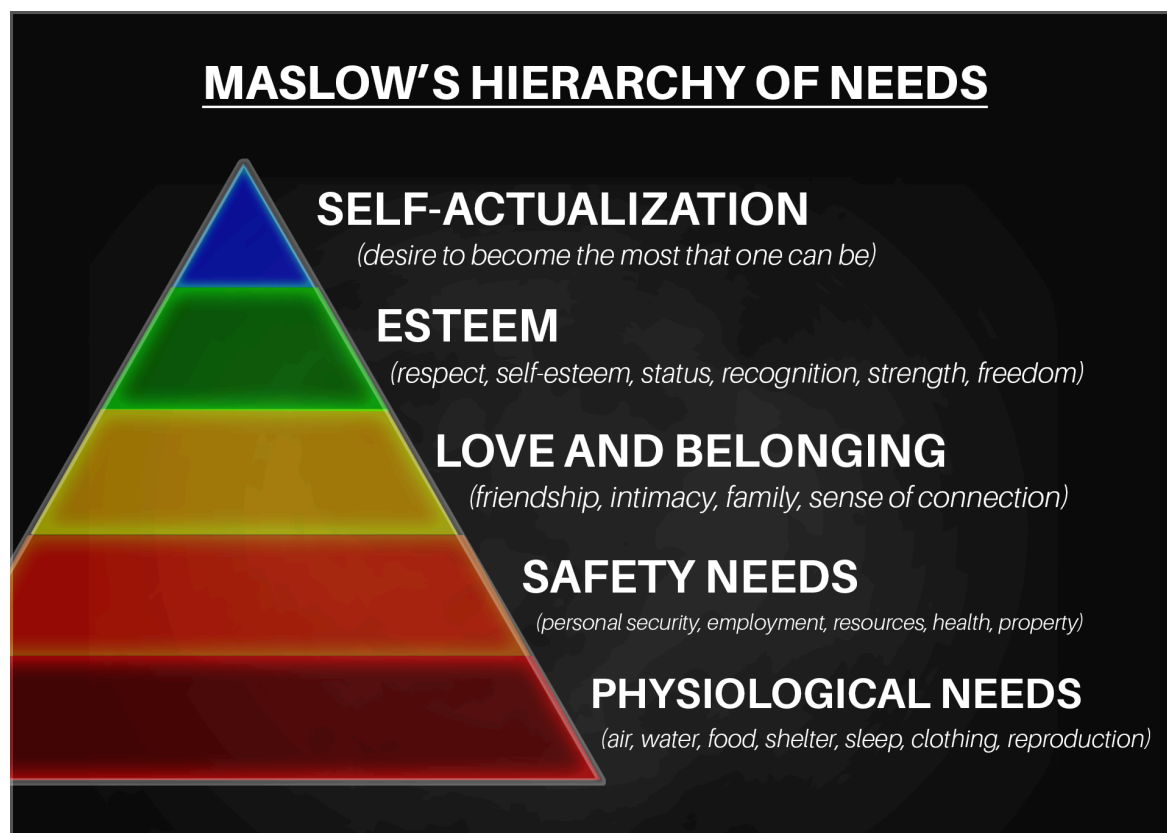
I guess, what I'm trying to say is that **the pain of investment** for me is immense and it caused me to gain a lot more confidence. *(I really learned to appreciate it now!)*

I always knew that Copy Elite was something else, but I never imagined something like this!
(It blew me out of the water!!!)

I gained an insane amount of confidence in the program, the systems we use, in all of you here, and probably, most importantly, in myself and my abilities to replicate the results we're getting here.
(The Exchange Catalyst in action!)

The first step to creating pain is understanding where pain comes from — *the pain origins*.

Maslow's hierarchy of needs explains what our core desires are as humans. When these core desires aren't being met, *we feel pain*.



From Maslow's work, we can derive the origin of where our pain comes from.

The 7 Pain Origins

1. Staying Alive (*Survival*)
2. Freedom From Fear/Danger (*Safety*)
3. Sexual Companionship (*Significant Other*)
4. Social Approval/Belonging (*Community*)
5. Status/Respect (*Superiority*)
6. Fulfilment of Purpose (*Self-Actualization*)
7. Enjoying Food & Drink (*Yummy*)

> Pain can be traced back to one or more of these desires missing OR being compromised.

> It starts from #1 and usually moves down to #6. (You move 'up' the pyramid.) #7 Can happen at any point lol. It doesn't really follow an order.

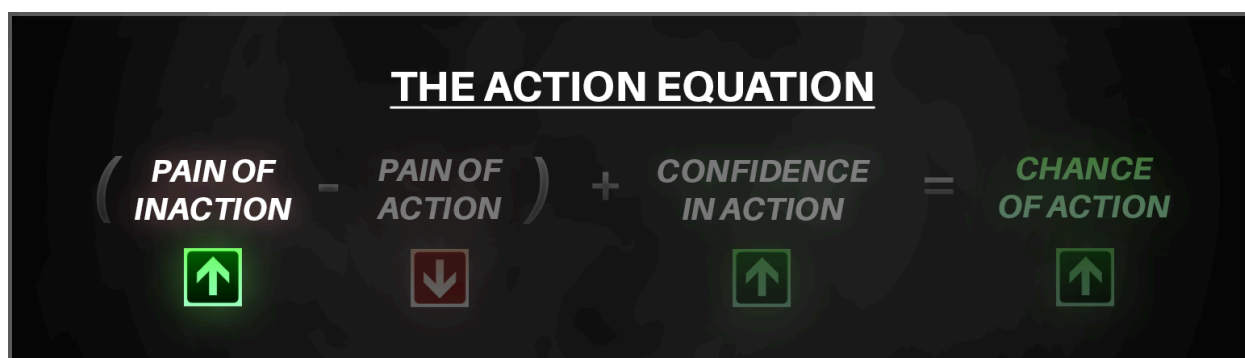
> Once an origin is solved for you, you usually want to solve it for your family.

> Most people don't realize the origin of their pain. They aren't 'aware' of it. They just feel 'bad' and blame that bad feeling on problems.

EX: You hear 'My life sucks' on a sales call but they can't verbalize all the reasons why. You have to dig it out of them, help them become aware of why they're in pain.

★ Your job as a copywriter is to bring awareness to the pain your audience is in and 'blame' that pain on a specific problem that your product/service solves.

Increasing Pain of Inaction



By increasing the pain of inaction (the pain of doing nothing & things getting worse), you increase the pressure they feel to take action to solve that problem.

> Stovetop Example

Your goal is to increase the pain they feel about the problem they have. increasing the pain they feel from doing nothing.

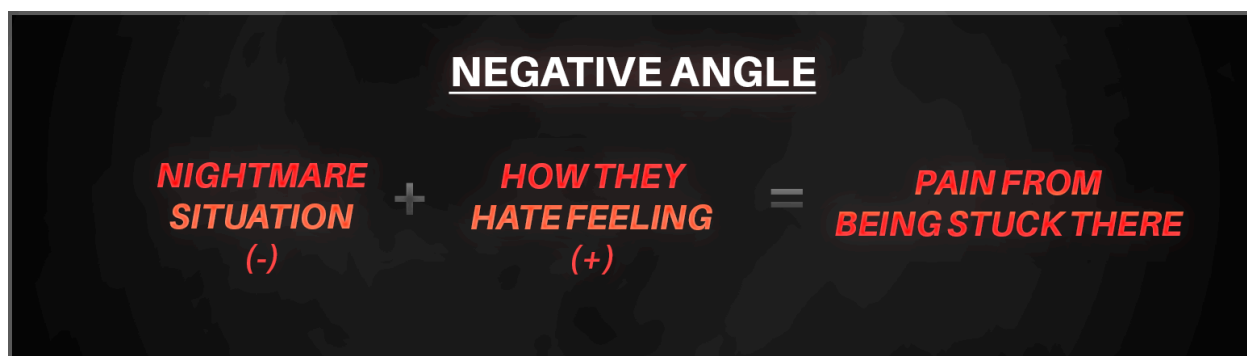
This can also be viewed as selling them on 'change'.

We do this by leveraging the work you've already done in module one: 'Specific Conditions'.

We can create pain using positive OR negative emotions — negative emotions are naturally more powerful, but when overused, they can come across as more 'pushy' and 'fear-monger-y.'



Positive Angle: By bringing their attention to their dream situation and how they want to feel, they'll subconsciously feel pain since they aren't in that situation currently & don't feel those positive emotions yet. (*Running to the light.*)



Negative Angle: By bringing their attention to their sucky past/present/future situation and how bad they felt/feel/will feel if they don't change, they'll feel pain. (*Running from the dark.*)

Basic Examples:

> **Fitness (+):** Copy this step-by-step calisthenics system to unlock skills that make people look at you like you're a famous athlete... in only 3–6 months

> **Fitness (-):** Copy this step-by-step calisthenics system & say goodbye to the embarrassment of looking, feeling, and BEING frail... in only 3–6 months

> **Ecom (+):** Once you know the ONE secret to finding a high-quality product for your store, you'll unlock what feels like 'an infinite money glitch' — feeling the rush of each 'cha-ching' knowing you're one step closer to living life completely FREE.

> **Ecom (-):** Without knowing the ONE secret to finding a high-quality product for your store, you will stay broke forever — never escaping the dreadful feeling of having to clock in to work monday.

> **YouTube Title (+):** The 5 Habits Of The TOP 1% Men

> YouTube Title (-): *The 5 Habits Keeping MEN Weak*

(We'll go over more examples later in the module, don't worry if you don't 100% get it yet!)

★ **BONUS TECH:** Storyselling - By telling the story of how you went from their painful current situation to their painless dream situation, you indirectly bring awareness to their pain. They imagine themselves in your shoes, and want to do/buy the method you used to get your results.

This works for every form of traffic but is specifically powerful when the product/service you're selling is attached to a person/personal brand.

> Copy Elite Example: <https://www.copyelite.io/home>

> Also check out: [Writing B2C VSL's](#) For a FULL Breakdown of Storyselling
(From High-Ticket Funnels Course)

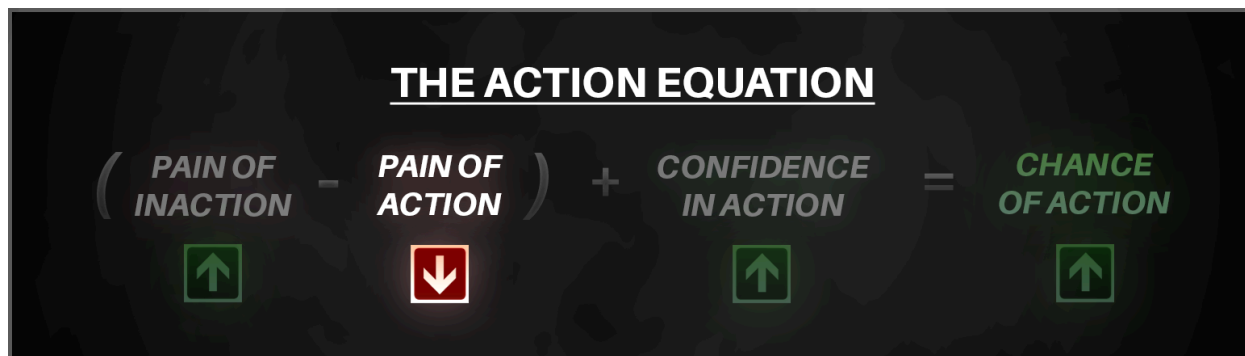
IMPORTANT: Don't forget everything you've learned so far! The amount of pain you're able to create depends on how well you understand and use specific conditions, general conditions, and the variables of likeness.

If you talk about situations and feelings that DON'T match what your audience feels/wants to feel, you won't create any pain. Specific conditions are everything.

Also, the more you nail the variable of likeness when creating pain, the more confidence they have that you can solve that pain later.

(We can also increase the pain of inaction by pushing the 'Big/FOMO' general condition and by using urgency/scarcity, covered in the future 'Urgency-Scarcity' module)

Decreasing Pain of Action



By **DECREASING** the perceived pain of taking the action you want your audience to take, the more likely they are to take the action.

- > This is done by following the previous 'Text-Subtext' module.
- > By using general & specific conditions to push the 'New, Easy, Safe' emotions, you'll decrease the perceived pain of taking the action.
- > Make the action seem **easy, simple, fast... painless.**

MAKE IT EASY FOR THEM TO TAKE THE ACTION YOU WANT!

(We'll cover some examples in a few minutes.)

Creating Confidence



If you've done your job well, you've increased the pain they feel from not taking the action, you've decreased the pain they feel around taking the action...

All that's left is to **increase their confidence** that taking the action WILL alleviate the pain they feel.

Phase 1: Creating Confidence In You/Your Client

(Incredibly Important When Your Product/Service Is Tied To A Personal/Brand)

(This is done throughout the whole marketing funnel, but usually emphasized at the 'top-of-funnel')

- > **Use The 11 Variables of Likeness** (From Previous 'Liking-Relatability' Module)
- > **Specificity**

Phase 2: Creating Confidence In Themselves

Once they're confident in your ability to help them, they also need to be confident that they can do their part to get their desired outcome. They need to believe in themselves.

This is vital when selling something that requires lots of effort on their part.

(Meditation vs. Anxiety Meds) (Weight Loss Coaching vs. Fat Loss Pills)

> Write down every reason why (false belief) someone could possibly have around them not being able to succeed with your product/service. *(Specific Conditions, Add To Conditions Deck)*

> Disprove those beliefs somewhere in your marketing/copy. *(Use logical arguments, case studies, testimonials, personal stories, etc.)*

Copy Elite Example:

- False Belief: *'I'm not a natural writer, so I won't make any money with copywriting.'*
- Disprove It:
 - *'87% of our most successful students claimed to be 'bad' at traditional writing in school. With most of them averaging C+ in English. Yet now some of them make anywhere from \$40k-\$150k/yr writing sales copy online.'*
 - *Testimonial of someone overcoming that same false belief.*
 - *Personal story of you failing English class, then making \$10k/m writing copy.*
 - *'Copywriting is nothing like the writing you did in school. That writing demanded you be as boring, statistical, and long-winded as possible. Copywriting is the opposite. You get paid to write as short as possible, as punchy as possible, and you get to be creative and funny... while making more \$\$ than your English teacher with a fraction of the effort lol.'*

Phase 3: Creating Confidence In The 'Method' & Your Solution
(The Opportunity & Your Product/Service)

- > Pushing The 'New/Only' Emotion In Your Marketing
- > Specificity
- > Testimonials/Results
- > General Excellence *(Professionalism)*
- > Clear/Simple Logical Argument/Problem Chain *(Common Sense) (Covered in 'Problem Chains')*
- > Proof/Appealing to Logic
 - Case Studies

- *Demonstrations*
- *Testimonials*
- *Quote from an authority*
- *Visuals (Charts & Graphs)*
- *Official Studies & Documents*
- *Risk-Reversal (Guarantees)*
- *Believability of Claims*

Becoming A Master Of Pain



Like every concept we've discussed, the best way to learn the skill of creating pain & confidence in your audience is through the Hyper-Learning Cycle.

1. **DO:** Practice daily by writing copy that uses negative and positive angles to stir pain. Focus on being specific in the situations and language that match your audience. Focus on matching how they want/don't want to FEEL.
2. **LEARN:** Re-watch this module and the previous ones.
3. **STUDY:** Study these [examples](#). Break down great funnels/copy you find using the same methods used in that example template. (*Break down at LEAST one piece of copy every workday.*)
4. **ITERATE:** Use what you learn from watching and studying to improve the copy you wrote earlier that day.

Let's do a 'study' cycle together live.

Like everything we've discussed, this takes practice. But once you learn how to stir pain, you'll become a profit-spawning machine.

You'll unlock the ability to hook your target audience, keep them engaged and 'feeling' your copy, and motivate them to take action. Good stuff.

Quick Reminder:

If you want me to crank more modules like this one, and even better, let me know any wins/breakthroughs/thoughts you have on this module/course in the #★course-wins channel in the Discord. It gives me so much energy to know all the pain I go through making these is worth it haha. Love y'all and see you in the next module. ❤️ -KJ

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join copy skool: <https://www.skool.com/copyskool>

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